

Salisbury square

No. 150

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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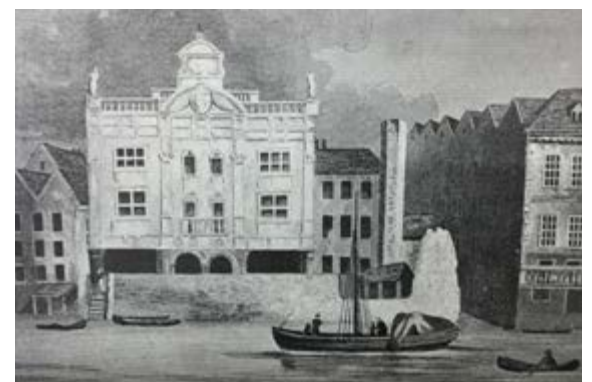
Sweeney Todd, the “demon barber of Fleet Street”, first appeared in 1846 in *The String of Pearls*, published by Edward Lloyd at 12 Salisbury Square. It was one of the cheap weekly stories known as “Penny Bloods”, which were popular with working-class readers and encouraged reading before education became widely available.

Salisbury Square was an important centre for theatre, books and newspapers. The Dorset Garden Theatre stood there in the 1600s, *Pamela* was published there in 1740, and Edward Lloyd later made it a hub for popular publishing.

Most of the square was destroyed in the Blitz, and nearly all that remained was demolished in 2021. The only surviving reminder is an obelisk to former Lord Mayor Robert Waithman, which will return as part of the new “Justice Quarter”.



Close-up of Robert Waithman Obelisk



The river frontage of the Dorset Garden Theatre